creation of City funding mechanisms and City fiscal activities, which does not involve any commitment to any project which may result in a potentially significant physical impact on the environment.

Severability. Should any section, subsection, paragraph, sentence, clause, or phrase of this Ordinance be declared unconstitutional or invalid for any reason, such declaration shall not affect the validity of the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Date of Adoption; Effective Date. Pursuant to Elections Code Section 9217, this Ordinance shall be considered adopted on the date that the City Council declares that the voters of the City of El Centro have approved this Ordinance by a vote of no less than a majority of the votes cast by the electors voting at the General Municipal Election held on Tuesday, November 3, 2026, and shall go into effect ten (10) days thereafter.

Execution. The Mayor shall sign this Ordinance and the City Clerk shall attest and certify to the passage and adoption of this Ordinance if a majority of the voters voting in the City's general municipal election on November 3, 2026, approve it.

Publication. The City Clerk shall cause this Ordinance to be published in the manner required by law.

PASSED, APPROVED AND ADOPTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE CITY OF El CENTRO at the General Municipal Election held on November 3, 2026.

IMPARTIAL ANALYSIS

The City Council of El Centro placed Measure T on the ballot for the November 3, 2026, election ("Measure"). The City of El Centro ("City") currently imposes a 0.5% transactions and use tax. This transactions and use tax is a general tax where the tax revenue collected is placed in the City's general fund for general governmental purposes. This Measure, if approved by voters, adds a new Article VII to Chapter 25 of the El Centro City Code, which establishes a new additional 0.5% transactions and use tax so that the total transactions and use tax rate is 1%. This tax will be in effect until ended by voters.

This tax would be assessed on the sale of tangible goods and the storage, use, or other consumption of such goods. This tax would be paid in addition to current sales taxes and would be collected at the same time and in the same manner as existing sales taxes. Both visitors and City residents would pay this tax on retail sales activity in the City of El Centro. Certain purchases, such as groceries or prescription medicine, would be exempt from the tax. The specific transactions and uses subject to the tax would be determined under State law and the regulations of the California Department of Tax and Fee Administration ("CDTFA"). The CDTFA would administer the tax under contract with the City.

If approved, this Measure is a general tax and will generate approximately $8,400,000 annually in additional revenue until ended by voters. Funds generated by the tax would be placed in the City's general fund, are not restricted, and may be used for any City general fund purpose. Further, it would be subject to annual independent auditing.

A "YES" vote is a vote to approve the Measure. A "NO" vote is a vote against the Measure. The Measure would take effect only if it receives a majority "YES" vote at the November 3, 2026, election.

The above statement is an impartial analysis of the Measure. If you desire a copy of the Measure, please call the City of El Centro's City Clerk's Office at 760-337-4564 and a copy will be mailed at no cost to you.

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Joanna Hoff
City Attorney
City of El Centro